

# **JOURNAL OF EDUCATIONAL MANAGEMENT AND SUPERVISION (JEMAS)**



Published in the Department of Educational Administration and Planning,  
Joseph Sarwuan Tarka University, Makurdi

## **TEACHER'S PARTICIPATION IN MANAGEMENT DECISION MAKING AND JOB PERFORMANCE IN PUBLIC SECONDARY SCHOOLS IN EDO NORTH SENATORIAL DISTRICT**

By

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### **Abstract**

This study examined teacher's participation in management decision making and job performance in public secondary schools in Edo North Senatorial District, Edo State. A correlational survey research design was adopted. The population comprised all 248 teachers and 37 principals in public secondary schools in the study area. Data were collected using two instruments titled: Teachers Involvement in Decision-making Questionnaire (TEPADEMQ) and Teachers Job performance questionnaire (TEJOPEQ). The face validity of the instrument was done by the researcher through the help of two other experts from the Department of Educational Foundations and management, Faculty of Education, Ambrose Alli University, Ekpoma. To determine the internal consistency of the instrument, the Cronbach alpha reliability method was used. The reliability value of 0.70 and 0.76 was obtained hence the instruments were suitable for usage. Research Question 1 and 2 were answered using Mean ( $\bar{X}$ ) and Standard Deviation (S.D). A bench mark of 2.50 was used to rate level of teacher's job performance, level of teacher's decision-making. Hypothesis 1 was tested using the Pearson product moment correlation coefficient at 0.05 level of significance. Findings showed that the level of job performance of teachers and teachers' participation in management decision making was low, a significant relationship existed between teachers'

involvement in decision making and teacher's job performance in Edo North Senatorial District. It was therefore recommended among others that school administration should ensure involvement of teachers in decision making in order to upgrade or create an environment that supports effective teaching

**Keywords:** Teacher's, Teacher's Participation, Management Decision Making, Job Performance, Public Secondary Schools, Edo North Senatorial District

## **Introduction**

Decision-making is a fundamental administrative process in every organization, including educational institutions. In schools, decision-making refers to the process through which administrators and staffs determine policies, allocate resources, solve problems, and set goals that guide the operation of the school system. Effective decision-making is essential because it influences the quality of teaching and learning, staffs' motivation, and the overall achievement of educational objectives. When schools' decision is carefully made, they help ensure that school activities are coordinated and aligned with educational goals. Ekwiekpamare and Letura (2025) is of the belief that effective decision-making enhances school productivity and promotes accountability among staff members. In educational institutions, decision relate to curriculum implementation, discipline management, staff welfare, and student development significantly shape the school environment. Therefore, decision-making is regarded as a central element of school administration because it determines how resources are utilized and how educational goals are achieved. When school leaders adopt collaborative decision-making approaches, teachers feel valued and become more committed to the success of the institution and participatory decision-making encourages teacher's motivation and professional commitment, which ultimately enhances the effectiveness of school operations and student outcomes (Ekwiekpamare and Letura 2025). Hence the place of management decision making in school cannot be over emphasized.

Management decision-making specifically refers to the structured process through which schools' administrators, particularly principals and other school leaders, making strategic and operational decisions that influence the functioning of the school. This decision may involve curriculum planning, student discipline, budgeting, staff deployment, school policy formulation, and other administrative matters. The role of school management decision-making is to ensure that the school system operates effectively and efficiently. Principals and school administrators are expected to provide leadership by guiding staffs' members and coordinating school activities through well-informed decisions. Effective management decision-making also promotes transparency, accountability, and collaboration among staff members. Osekita et al (2025) emphasized that when school leaders adopt inclusive and consultative decision-making styles, teachers become more committed to the goals of the school and demonstrate higher levels of productivity. Authoritarian decision-making may reduce teachers' moral and limit their willingness to contribute actively to school development. Therefore, school management decision-

making plays a crucial role in shaping the organizational climate of schools and ensuring that educational policies and programmes are successfully implemented.

Teachers' participation in school management decision-making refers to the extent to which teachers are involved in discussions, consultations, and decisions regarding school policies, programs and administrative activities. Teachers are the professionals who interact directly with students and understand the practical realities of classroom teaching; therefore, their contributions to decision-making are valuable for effective school management. Participation may occur through staff meetings, committees, departmental discussions, and collaborative planning processes. When teachers are involved in decision-making, they develop a sense of ownership and responsibility toward school policies and programs, according to Dauda and Mohammed (2011), teachers participation enhances moral, strengthens, commitment to organizational goals, and improves communication between teachers and school administrators. Moreover, involving teachers in decisions related to curriculum development, discipline management, and instructional strategies enables schools to benefit from teachers' professional expertise while in turn enhances teachers' job performance.

Teachers' job performance refers to the extent to which teachers effectively carry out their professional responsibilities in the school system. These responsibilities include lesson preparation, class room instruction, and assessment of students' learning outcomes, classroom management, and record keeping participation in school activities. And collaboration with colleagues and school administrators. High teacher job performance is essential for improving students' academic achievement and maintaining the quality of education in schools. Teachers who perform effectively demonstrate competence in subject delivery, effective classroom management, and moral development. Several factors influence teachers' job performance, such as motivation, professional training, working condition, leadership style of the school administrators, and opportunities for professional participation in school governance. When teachers are satisfied with their work environment and feel respected by school management, they are more likely to exhibit higher level of dedication and productivity. Consequently, improving teachers' performance seems to remain a key concern for educational administrators and policy makers because it directly affects the overall effectiveness of the educational system.

Several empirical studies have examined the level of teacher's job performance in educational institutions for instance, Omoze (2025) examined human resource development and workplace variables as predictors of job performance of teachers in public secondary schools in Edo State. The study adopted a correlational survey research design. The population consisted of 1,846 teachers in 296 public schools in Edo State. The findings of the study revealed that the level of job performance among teachers in public secondary schools in Edo State was low. Similarly, Dauda and Muhammed (2021) investigated the relationship between motivation and teaching performance on one hand, and motivation and research performance on the other hand among

academic staff of Ibrahim Badamasi Babaginda University, Lapai (IBBUL), and Nigeria. A sample of 141 academic staff, representing about 64% of the total population of 219 academic staff in the University, was used for the study. The result indicated that the level of job performance among the teachers was moderate. In another related study, Wang (2012) analyzed the concept of university teacher's performance by examining variables such as organizational commitment, job stress, mental health, and achievement motivation. The findings revealed that the overall level of job performance among the teacher studied was poor. Furthermore, Indhumathi (2011) investigated job satisfaction, occupational commitment, organizational commitment, and job performance among secondary school teachers. A total of 444 teachers at the secondary school level were randomly selected for the study. The findings showed that the level of job performance among the teachers was high.

Chika and Igbaseimokumo (2019) investigated the influence of teacher's participation in decision-making on their job performance in secondary schools in Bayelsa State. The study adopted a survey research design the population of study consisted 3,765 teachers in public secondary schools. The findings of the study revealed that teachers' participation in decision-making in schools was low. This implies that teachers were not adequately involved in the administrative decisions that affect the management and functioning of their schools. Similarly, Merva et al. (2025) explored the involvement of secondary school teachers in school decision-making through the lived experiences of teachers. The study adopted a phenomenological research design and involved twenty-four purposively selected participants. Data were collected through in-depth interviews and analyzed using thematic content analysis. The findings revealed two key themes of teacher participation, namely active committee participation roles. The results indicated that structured collaboration and leadership opportunities enable teachers to influence curriculum implementation, school policies, and other operational activities. This suggests that teacher's participation in decision-making in the studied schools was high. In another related study, Barineka and Bulopakye (2024) examined the relationship between school management practices and teachers job performance in senior secondary schools in Rivers State. The findings of the study revealed that management practices such as team building, strategic planning, staff involvement, communication, and capacity building programmes had a high and significant relationship with teacher's job performance in public senior secondary schools in Rivers State. However, instructional supervision and motivation practices showed a low but significant relationship with teacher's job performance in the schools.

Evwiekpamare and Letura (2025) investigated the influence of participatory leadership in decision-making on teacher's job satisfaction in public secondary schools in Obio-Akpor Local Government Area of Rivers State, Nigeria. The study examined the extent to which school administrators involve teachers in the decision-making process and how such involvement affects their level of satisfaction with jobs. The findings of the study revealed that there was a significant relationship between participatory leadership in decision-making and teachers job satisfaction. The result implies that when teachers are actively involved in making decisions that affect school administration and instructional processes, they intend to experience higher levels of satisfaction and demonstrate improved commitment to their work.

Similarly, Osekita et al. (2025) examined the relationship between participation in decision-making and teachers job performance in secondary schools in Ekiti State, Nigeria. The study sought to determine whether the extent of teacher's involvement in school administrative decisions could influence how effectively they perform their teaching responsibilities. The findings revealed that there was a significant relationship between participation in decision-making and teachers job performance. This suggest that teachers who are given the opportunity to contribute to school decision tend to exhibit higher levels of dedication, responsibility, and effectiveness in carrying out their professional duties. In another related study, Ayebgusi and Ogunlade (2020) investigated the relationship between teacher's decisional participation and job satisfaction in secondary schools in Ekiti State. The study emphasized the important of teacher's involvement in administrative and instructional decision-making processes within the school system. The findings revealed that there was a significant relationship between participation in decision-making and teachers job satisfaction in the study area. The result indicates that when teachers are given opportunities to express their opinions and contribute to decision affecting school polices and operations, it enhances their motivation, satisfaction, and overall effectiveness in their professional roles.

The quality of education in any school system largely depends on the effectiveness and commitment of teachers in carrying out their professional responsibilities due to the fact that they directly interact with students and implement the curriculum designed to achieve educational objectives. For this reason, teacher's job performance has become a major concern for educational administrators, policymakers, and stakeholders in the education sector. Consequently, improving teacher's job performance has remained an important priority in efforts to strengthen the quality of secondary education. Despite the recognized importance of teacher's job performance, evidence from many public secondary schools in Nigeria suggests that the level of teacher's effectiveness in performing their professional responsibilities is not always satisfactory. Report from school inspectors, educational administrators, and researchers have indicated persistent concerns such as inadequate lesson preparation, irregular classroom supervision, limited teacher commitment to instructional duties, and poor participation in school programmes. In some case teachers may demonstrate minimal enthusiasm towards school responsibilities, which may negatively affect students' academic outcomes and the general functioning of the school system. These challenges have raised concern among education stakeholders about the factors that may be influencing teacher's attitudes toward their work and their overall level of job performance in public secondary schools.

Centralized decision making remains a common feature in many secondary schools, where authority is concentrated in the hands of principals and top administrators, often with minimal input from teachers. However, teachers are key stakeholders in the educational process, as they are directly involved in classroom instruction, curriculum delivery and student development.

Excluding them from decisions related to curriculum implementation, school policies, discipline management and instructional planning could lead to feelings of disconnection and undervaluation. This situation may weaken communication between teachers and school administrators and create an organizational climate that discourages collaboration and professional engagement.

When teachers perceive school policies as imposed directives rather than collectively developed initiatives, they may exhibit resistance, reduced morale and limited commitment to the successful implementation of school programs. In contrast, participatory decision making through staff meetings, committees and collaborative planning encourages a sense of ownership and professional recognition among teachers. Such inclusion could enhance motivation, improve instructional practices and increase teachers' willingness to contribute meaningfully to the achievement of school goals. Although existing literature highlights the importance of participatory decision making in enhancing organizational effectiveness, there is a noticeable gap in empirical research examining its relationship with teachers' job performance, particularly within the context of public secondary schools in Edo North Senatorial District. While factors such as remuneration, workload and working conditions have been widely studied in relation to teachers' performance, the role of teachers' participation in school management decisions has not received sufficient attention in this region. Therefore, this study examined the relationship between teachers' participation in management decision making and job performance in public secondary schools in Edo North Senatorial District.

### **Objective of the Study**

The main purpose of the study was to investigate the relationship between teachers' participation in management decision making and job performance in public secondary schools in Edo North Senatorial District. Specifically, the study:

1. determined the level of teacher's job performance in public secondary schools in Edo North Senatorial District;
2. established the level of teacher's participation in school management decision-making in public secondary schools in Edo North Senatorial District;
3. find out the relationship between teacher's participation in school management decision-making and their job performance in public secondary schools in Edo North Senatorial District.

### **Research Questions**

1. What is the level of teacher's job performance in public secondary schools in Edo North Senatorial District?
2. What is the level of teacher's participation in management decision-making in public secondary schools in Edo North Senatorial District?

3. What is the relationship between teacher's participation in management decision-making and job performance in public secondary schools in Edo North Senatorial District?

### **Research Hypotheses**

1. There is no significant relationship between teacher's participation in management decision-making and job performance in public secondary schools in Edo North Senatorial District.

### **Methodology**

The design of this study was the correlational research design. The researchers employed the correlational design to explain how involvement of teachers in decision-making relate with their job performance in public secondary schools in Edo North District. The population consisted 37 principals and 248 teachers. The instrument adopted for the study is the questionnaire titled: Teachers Involvement in Decision-making Questionnaire (TEPADEMQ) and Teachers Job performance questionnaire (TEJOPEQ). The first instrument was carefully designed and adopted from the work of Imoroa (2018), while the second instrument was self-developed by the researchers. The face validity of the instrument was done by the researcher through the help of two other experts from the Department of Educational Foundations and management, Faculty of Education, Ambrose Alli University, Ekpoma. To determine the internal consistency of the instrument, the Cronbach alpha reliability coefficient was used. The reliability value of 0.70 and 0.76 were considered suitable to be used in the main administration of both instruments. The researchers and two trained research assistances administered the instruments to the respondents in the stud location. Research Question 1 and two were answered using Mean ( $\bar{X}$ ) and Standard deviation (S.D). A bench mark of 2.50 was used to rate level of teacher's job performance, level of teacher's decision-making while hypothesis 1 was tested using the Pearson product moment correlation coefficient. The one hypothesis was tested at 0.05 level of significance.

### **Results**

**Researcher Question 1:** what is the level of teacher's job performance in public secondary schools in Edo North Senatorial District?

**Table 1: Mean and Standard Deviation on the level of Teachers job performance**

**N= 37**

| S/N | Items                                                                                        | $\bar{X}$ | S.d.  | Remarks |
|-----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------|---------|
|     | Prepares lesson plan to meet instructional objectives.                                       | 2.199     | .554  | Low     |
|     | Plans for continuing assessment/evaluation in lessons.                                       | 2.923     | .686  | High    |
|     | Choice the textbooks needed for a lesson before going to class.                              | 2.474     | .758  | Low     |
|     | Choose the instructional material needed to illustrate a new concept.                        | 1.184     | .668  | Low     |
|     | Utilizes teaching strategies that are consistent with the selected instructional objectives. | 2.026     | 1.018 | Low     |
|     | Makes the lessons engaging, relevant, and challenging.                                       | 2.224     | .776  | Low     |
|     | Clearly explains a new concept to students during class instruction.                         | 1.717     | .840  | Low     |
|     | Uses common examples to explain a difficult concept.                                         | 1.651     | .723  | Low     |
|     | Use classroom-based assessments to monitor instruction.                                      | 2.335     | 1.343 | Low     |
|     | Evaluates individual student progress regularly                                              | 1.960     | .873  | High    |
|     | maintains records for report card that will be given to students' parents,                   | 1.783     | .682  | High    |
|     | Asks students questions from time to time during lesson.                                     | 1.110     | .415  | Low     |
|     | Teaches classroom behavior expectations to students.                                         | 1.184     | .668  | Low     |
|     | Maintains an effectively organized classroom.                                                | 2.401     | .561  | Low     |
|     | Manages the limited class facilities available to teach students in class.                   | 2.272     | .964  | Low     |
|     | Allows all students to participate in the lesson.                                            | 2.710     | .530  | High    |
|     | Establishes the guidelines on what is tolerable and what is not.                             | 1.474     | .687  | Low     |
|     | Shows consistency and fairness in dealing with students' behavior.                           | 1.074     | .261  | Low     |
|     | Maintains order and discipline in the classroom.                                             | 3.563     | .684  | High    |
|     | Disciplines students in a consistent and respectful manner.                                  | 3.272     | .964  | High    |
|     | <b>Overall mean</b>                                                                          | 2.08      |       |         |

Results in Table 1 indicate that teachers recorded high mean ratings (2-71-3.56) in area such as continuous assessment planning, regular evaluation of students' progress, record keeping for report cards, promoting student participation, maintaining classroom discipline and ensuring consistent student management. However, low mean ratings (1.07-2.40) were observed in critical instructional practices, including lesson planning aligned with objectives, selection of appropriate textbooks and instructional materials, use of effective teaching strategies, clarity in explaining concepts, use of relevant examples, classroom-based assessment during instruction, questioning techniques, classroom organization and management of available facilities. The overall mean score for teachers' job performance was 2.08, which is below the criterion mean of 2.50. This indicates that the level of job performance among teachers in public secondary schools in Edo North Senatorial District is low.

**Research Question 2:** what is the level of teacher's participation in management decision-making in public schools in Edo North Senatorial District?



**Table 2: Mean Standard Deviation on level of teachers' participation in management decision-making**

| N=248 |                                             |           |       |         |
|-------|---------------------------------------------|-----------|-------|---------|
| s/n   | Items                                       | $\bar{X}$ | S.D.  | Remarks |
|       | Examination committing                      | 2.199     | .554  | Low     |
|       | School building Committee.                  | 2.923     | .686  | High    |
|       | Disciplinary Committee.                     | 2.474     | .758  | Low     |
|       | Lesson Planning Committee.                  | 1.184     | .668  | Low     |
|       | Extra curriculum activities.                | 2.026     | 1.018 | Low     |
|       | Parents and Teachers Association Committee. | 2.224     | .776  | Low     |
|       | <b>Overall mean</b>                         | 2.17      |       |         |

The results from the table showed that teachers' participation in management decision making varies across different areas. High involvement was recorded only in the school building committee (mean = 2.92, SD = 0.69), indicating active participation in school infrastructure and maintenance with relatively consistent responses among teachers. In contrast, teachers' involvement was low in several key committees, including the examination committee (mean = 2.20, SD = 0.55), disciplinary committee (mean = 2.47, SD = 0.76), lesson planning committee (mean = 1.18, SD = 0.67), extra-curricular activities (mean = 2.22, SD = 0.78). These findings suggest limited teacher participation in academic, disciplinary, instructional and co-curricular decision-making processes. The overall mean score of 2.17 indicates that teachers' participation in management decision making in public secondary schools in Edo North Senatorial District was low.

**Hypothesis 1:** There is no significant relationship between teacher's participation in management decision-making and job performance in public schools secondary schools in Edo North Senatorial District.

**Table 3:** Analysis on relationship between teacher's participation in management decision making and job performance

| Variables                                     | N  | $\bar{X}$ | S.D  | Pearson<br>r-coefficient | p-value | Remarks                              |
|-----------------------------------------------|----|-----------|------|--------------------------|---------|--------------------------------------|
| Teacher's Participation in<br>Decision making | 37 | 2.17      | .792 | 0.418*                   | 0.003   | Null hypothesis<br>rejected (p<0.05) |
| Job Performance                               |    | 2.08      | .876 |                          |         |                                      |

**Correlation is significant at the 0.05 level (2-tailed).**

The results in Table 3 show the relationship between teachers' participation in decision making and their job performance. The analysis revealed a mean score of 2.17 (SD = 0.79) for teachers' participation in decision making and a mean score of 2.08 (SD = 0.88) for job performance. The Pearson correlation coefficient ( $r = 0.418$ ) indicates a moderate positive relationship between the two variables. This suggests that as teachers' participation in decision making increases, their job performance also tends to improve. Furthermore, the p-value of 0.003 is less than the 0.05 level of significance, indicating that the relationship is statistically significant. Therefore, the null

hypothesis, which states that there is no significant relationship between teachers' participation in decision making and job performance, is rejected. This implies that teachers' involvement in decision making processes plays a significant role in enhancing their job performance in public secondary schools in Edo North Senatorial District.

### **Discussion of Findings**

Findings from the table 1 revealed that the level of job performance among teachers in public secondary schools in Edo North Senatorial District was low. The low level of job performance observed may be attributed to several factors such as occupational stress, heavy workload, limited instructional resources, inadequate motivation, and poor working condition that often characterized many public secondary schools in Nigeria. The present findings is consistent with the study conducted by Omoze (2025) who was examined human resources development and workplace variables as predictors of job performance of teachers in public secondary schools in Edo State. The findings of that study revealed that the level of job performance among teachers in public secondary schools in Edo State was low. The finding of the present study also supports the result reported by Wang (2012), who analyzed the concept of university teachers' performance by examining variables such as organizational commitment, job stress, mental health, and achievement motivation. Wang's findings revealed that the overall level of job performance among the teachers studied was poor. However, the result of the present study disagrees with the findings of Dauda and Mohammed (2012), who investigated the relationship between motivation and teaching performance on one hand, and motivation and research performance on the other hand among academic staff of Ibrahim Badamasi Babangida University, Lapai, Nigeria. Their findings indicated that the level of job performance among the teachers was moderate. Similarly, the finding of this study does not support the result of Indhumathi (2011), who investigated job satisfaction, occupational commitment, organizational commitment, and job performance among secondary school teachers and found that the level of job performance among teachers was high.

Findings from Table 2 showed that teacher's participation in management decision making in public secondary schools in Edo North Senatorial District was low. This implies that teachers in the area may have limited opportunities to participate in important school activities such as committee meetings, policy discussions, curriculum planning, disciplinary committees, and administrative responsibilities that contribute to the smooth running of the school. Low level of involvement in school committees observed in this study suggest that school management in many public secondary schools still operates in a highly centralized manner where major decisions are largely taken by school administrators without adequate consultation with teachers. The finding of the present study is consistent with the study conducted by Chika and Igbaseimokumo (2019), who investigated the influence of teachers' participation in decision-making on their job performance in secondary schools in Bayelsa State. The findings of their study revealed that teachers' participation in decision-making in schools was low. The finding of this study also supports the result reported by Merva et al. (2025), who explored the involvement of secondary school teachers in school decision-making through the lived experiences of teachers. Their findings indicated that

structured collaboration among teachers was low. However, the finding of this study disagrees with that of Barineka and Bulopakaye (2024), who examined the relationship between school management practices and teachers' job performance in senior secondary schools in Rivers State. Their findings revealed that management practices such as team building, strategic planning, staff involvement, communication, and capacity-building programs had a high and significant relationship with teachers' job performance.

Findings from Table 3 revealed that there is a significant relationship between teachers' participation in management decision-making and job performance in public secondary schools in Edo North Senatorial District. Which implies that when teachers are given opportunity to participate in decision that affect school policies, instructional strategies, curriculum implementation, and general school administration, they tend to develop a stronger sense of belonging and commitment to the school. Such involvement could encourage them to contribute ideas, share professional experiences, and take responsibility for the successful implementation of decisions. The finding of the present study is consistent with the study conducted by Evwiekpamare and Letura (2025), who investigated the influence of participatory leadership in decision-making on teachers' job satisfaction in public secondary schools in Obio-Akpor Local Government Area of Rivers State, Nigeria. Their findings revealed that there was a significant relationship between participatory leadership in decision-making and teachers' job satisfaction. Similarly, the finding of the present study supports the study carried out by Osekita et al. (2025), who examined the relationship between participation in decision-making and teachers' job performance in secondary schools in Ekiti State, Nigeria. Their findings revealed that there was a significant relationship between participation in decision-making and teachers' job performance. The finding of this study also agrees with the work of Ayegbusi and Ogunlade (2020), who investigated the relationship between teachers' decisional participation and job satisfaction in secondary schools in Ekiti State. Their findings revealed that there was a significant relationship between participation in decision-making and teachers' job satisfaction in the study area.

## **Conclusion**

Based on the results, the researcher concludes that level of job performance of teachers was low, teachers' participation in management decision making was low, a significant relationship existed between teachers' participation in management decision making and teacher's job performance in Edo North Senatorial District.

## **Recommendations**

Based on the results, the following recommendations were made:

1. The government should strengthen and properly structure committees such as lesson planning, examination, disciplinary and co-curricular committees. Teachers should be given clear roles and encouraged to actively participate in these committees to enhance their sense of responsibility and belonging.

2. School administration should ensure involvement of teachers in decision making in order to upgrade or create an environment that supports effective teaching
3. Schools' administrators should actively involve teachers in decision making processes, especially in areas such as curriculum planning, instructional strategies, discipline policies and school management. This can be achieved through regular staff meetings, inclusive committees and open forums for idea sharing.

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